INCH-POUND

A-A-55281
9 JUNE 1995

(**PROPOSED**)

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CLOTH, POPLIN: polyester/cotton, precured, soil release durable press treatment

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for MIL-C-43865 for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers the requirements for a blended polyester and cotton poplin cloth which has been chemically treated with a cured, durable press and soil release finish. The cloth is intended for use in shorts and skirts for the Army women's training duty uniform and the Navy women's utility/field uniform.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

2.1 General description. The plain weave cloth shall consist of 2-ply warp and filling yarn made from a blend of 45 to 70 percent polyester and the remaining percentage cotton, based on the dry weight of the cloth. The polyester fiber shall be polyethylene glycol terephthalate and the cotton shall be carded and combed. The cloth shall be desized, scoured, mercerized, bleached and heat set prior to dyeing. The color of the finished cloth shall be Blue 3364 or as specified in the contract or purchase order and shall match the standard sample. The color of the cured cloth shall match the standard sample under natural (north sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500° Kelvin and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2800° Kelvin.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FQSD, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19145-5099.

AMSC N/A FSC 8305

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2.2 Physical requirements . The finished cloth shall conform to the following physical requirements.

2.2.1 The cured cloth shall have a minimum weight of 6.5 ounces per square yard when tested according to ASTM-D 3776, Option C. The yarns per inch shall contain a minimum of 68 for the warp and 34 for the filling when tested according to ASTM-D 3775. Prior to testing for yarns per inch, the samples shall be conditioned as directed in ASTM-D 1776 - Practice for Conditioning Textiles for Testing. The minimum breaking strength shall be a minimum of 125 pounds for the warp and 75 pounds for the filling when tested according to ASTM-D 5034. The width of the cloth shall be as specified in the contract and shall be the minimum acceptable width inclusive of selvages.

2.2.2 The cured cloth shall have a dimensional change of not more than 2.0 percent in the warp or filling direction when tested in accordance with AATCC 135 (Table I [(1) V A]) with the following exceptions: The specimens shall be 22 X 22 inches with 18 inch benchmarks and 140 grams of soap shall be used.

2.2.3 The cloth shall have a seam efficiency of not less than 90 percent when tested in accordance with Method 5110 of FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods. The needle shall measure 0.044 $\pm$ 0.001 inch across the blade at the eye. The thread shall be polyester/cotton in accordance with A-A-50199, ticket No. 50, 2 ply for the needle and ticket No. 70, 2 ply for the looper.

2.2.4 The pH value of the water extract of the cloth shall be no less than 5.0 nor more than 8.5 when tested in accordance with Method 2811 of FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods. The starch and protein content including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material of the dyed cloth prior to treatment for nonfibrous material shall not exceed 2.0 percent when tested in accordance with ASTM-D 629 (Section 9).

2.2.5 The finished cloth shall be given an approved durable press and soil release treatment. The cloth shall be processed so that the cured cloth shall have an appearance and soil release rating (after 5 launderings) of 3.3 minimum when tested in accordance with AATCC 130 with the following exceptions: The appearance test may be performed on the same pieces used for the dimensional stability test. Evaluation shall be in accordance with AATCC Test Method 124. The soil release test shall be performed after the fourth wash and dry cycle on the specimens used for dimensional stability. The washing and drying conditions used for the dimensional stability test shall apply.

2.2.6 The finished cloth shall contain no more labile sulfur than the standard sample when tested in accordance with Method 2020 of FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods.

2.2.7 The finished cloth shall show colorfastness to light, laundering (after 3 cycles), perspiration and crocking equal to or better than the standard sample. As a limit of acceptability or when no standard sample is available, the finished cloth shall show a

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minimum rating or "4" (good) colorfastness to light, laundering, perspiration (acid and alkaline) and a minimum rating of "4" (good) fastness to dry crocking and a minimum rating of "3" (fair) colorfastness to wet crocking when tested in accordance with the indicated test methods:

AATCC 16 - Colo rfastness to Light, with the following exception: When a color change equal to step 4 on the gray scale for change in color is evident in either sample being evaluated or the standard sample, exposure shall be continued for an additional number of hours equal to the number of hours at which the color change was apparent. Specimens which do not show a color change until 80 AFU's shall be returned to the machine for a total exposure period not to exceed 140 hours.

AATCC 61, Test 3A - Colorfastness to Laun dering, with the following exceptions: The specimens must be dried after each of the three laundering cycles. The soap solution shall contain 0.5 percent by weight, P-D 245, Detergent, Laundry, and Hand Dishwashing (Granular) Type II, in water hardness not over 50 parts per million. The sample size shall be 4.0 $\pm$ 0.5, with 10 stainless steel balls in each cylinder and the rotation time shall be 30 minutes.

AATCC 15 - Colorfastness to Perspiration with the following exception: The test for colorfastness for acid and alkaline solution shall apply.

AATCC 8 - Colorfastness to Crocking (Dry and Wet).

2.3 Length and put-up . Unless otherwise specified, the finished cloth shall be furnished in continuous lengths of not less than 40 yards and shall be put up on rolls.

2.4 Label/tag . Each roll shall be labeled or ticketed for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act. The face side of the cloth shall be identified by stamping the word "Face" at each end of the roll. This label/tag shall be located so that it is completely visible on each roll, causes no damage to the roll, remains on the roll as cloth lengths are distributed.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Regulatory requirements . The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) to the maximum extent practicable.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Certification . The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this commercial item description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices, and is the same product

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offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract or purchase order.

4.2 Market Acceptability . The following market acceptability criteria are necessary to document the quality of the product to be provided under this commercial item description.

4.2.1 The company offering the cloth, put up on rolls, or generically similar cloth as described herein, must have been sold to the commercial market or to the Government for at least 2 years.

4.3 Warranty . The item offered shall include the standard warranty given to the commercial market beginning with the date of delivery of the individual item.

4.4. Visual examination . The cloth shall be examined as indicated in 4.4.1 through 4.4.1.4.

4.4.1 Yard-by-yard examination . Each roll in the sample shall be examined on the face side only. When the total yardage in the roll does not exceed 100 yards, the entire yardage in the roll shall be examined. When the total yardage in the roll exceeds 100 yards, only 100 yards shall be examined. All defects as defined as Section I of FED-STD-4 - Glossary of Fabric Imperfections, which are clearly visible at normal inspection distance (3 feet) shall be scored and assigned demerit points as specified in the contract or purchase order, except that only those slubs and knots which exceed the limits shown on Sears Fabric Defect Scale "D" for slubs and "C" for knots, shall be scored. No linear yard (increments of 1 yard on the measuring device of the inspection machine) from any one roll within the sample shall be penalized more than 4 points. The sample size shall be in accordance with the following:

Lot size (yards)	Sample size (rolls) 1/
3200 or less	8
3201 up to and including 10,000	13
10,001 and over	20

1/ No more than one roll shall be taken from any shipping container unless the number of shipping containers in the lot is less than the required number rolls in which case all shipping containers shall be present in the sample.

The lot shall be unacceptable if the points per 100 square yards of the total yardage examined exceeds 25 points. The lot shall be unacceptable if the points per 100 square yards of two or more individual rolls exceeds 38 points. If one roll exceeds 38 points per 100 square yards, a second sample of 20 rolls shall be examined only for individual roll quality examination. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more rolls in the second sample exceeds 38

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points per 100 square yards. Point computation for lot quality and individual roll quality shall be as follows:

$$\frac{\text{Total points scored in sample X 3600}}{\text{Constructed width of cloth (inches) X total yds inspected}} = \frac{\text{Points per}}{100 \text{ sq.yds.}}$$

4.4.1.1 Demerit points . Demerit points shall be assigned as follows:

For defects 3 inches or less in any dimension	- one point
For defects exceeding 3 inches, but not exceeding 6 inches in any dimension	- two points
For defects exceeding 6 inches, but not exceeding 9 inches in any dimension	- three points
For defects exceeding 9 inches in any dimension	- four points

The following defects, when present, shall be scored four points for each yard in which they occur:

Baggy, ridgy or wavy cloth; width less than specified; poor dye peneration, mottled, streaky or cloudy; overall uncleanness.

4.4.1.2 Length examination . During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll in the sample shll be examined for length. Any length found to be less than the minimum specified or more than 2 yards less than the length marked on the ticket shall be considered a defect with respect to length. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more rolls in the sample are defective in respect to length. The lot shall be unacceptable if the total of the actual lengths of rolls in the sample is less than the total of the lengths marked on the tickets. the rolls examined shall be those selected for the examination of individual rolls.

4.4.1.3 Examination for shade . During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll in the sample shall be examined for shade. Any roll in the sample off-shade, shaded side to side, side to center, or end to end shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot represented by the sample.

4.4.1.4 Examination for face identification and compliance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act . During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll in the sample shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more of these defects occur:

Face identification missing from either or both ends.
Not labeled or ticketed in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation, packing, and marking . The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Acceptance criteria . Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6.2 Approval of durable press resin and soil release agents . Approval of the durable press resin and soil release agents for utilization under this document is the responsibility of the US Army Natick Laboratories,(GL), Natick MA 01760, and is based on extensive tests, including those for human toxicity which are not set forth in this document. Because of the time necessary to conduct full evaluations, only those treatments approved and so listed in the invitation for bids or request for proposals shall be considered acceptable for the related procurement.

6.3 Source of Government documents . Copies of military and Federal documents are available from:

Department of the Navy
Defense Printing Service
Detachment Office
700 Robbins Avenue, BLDG 4D
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5093

Rules And Regulations Under The Textile Fiber Products Identification Act - Application for copies may be addressed to:

Federal Trade Commission
Washington, DC 20580

6.3.1 Sources of non-Government documents

ASTM Test Methods - Applications for copies should be addressed to:

American Society For Testing and Materials
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187

AATCC Test Methods - Applications for copies should be addressed to:

American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists
P.O. Box 12215
Triangle Park, NC 27709-2215

Sears Fabric Defect Scales and Fabric Defect Replica Kits are available from:

Sears, Roebuck and Company
Department 817, ATTN : BSC 23-29
Sears Tower
Chicago, IL 60684

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodian
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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
DLA - CT

Project
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